Types of hernia

1. **Reducible:** The protruding mass can be placed back into the abdominal cavity.
2. **Irreducible:** the protruding mass cannot be moved back into the abdomen.
3. **Incarcerated:** An irreducible hernia in which the intestinal flow is completely obstructed.
4. **Strangulated:** An irreducible hernia in which the blood and intestinal flow are completely obstructed. Develops when the loop of intestine in the sac becomes twisted or swollen and a constriction is produced at the neck of the sac.

Classification of hernia by site

1. Inguinal hernia

Hernia into the inguinal canal (more common in males.)

Indirect inguinal hernia: Due to weakness of the abdominal wall at the point through which the spermatic cord emerges in the male and the round ligament of uterus in the female. Through this opening the hernia extends down, the inguinal canal and often into the scrotum or the labia.

❖ Direct inguinal hernia: Passes through the posterior inguinal wall.

2. Femoral hernia

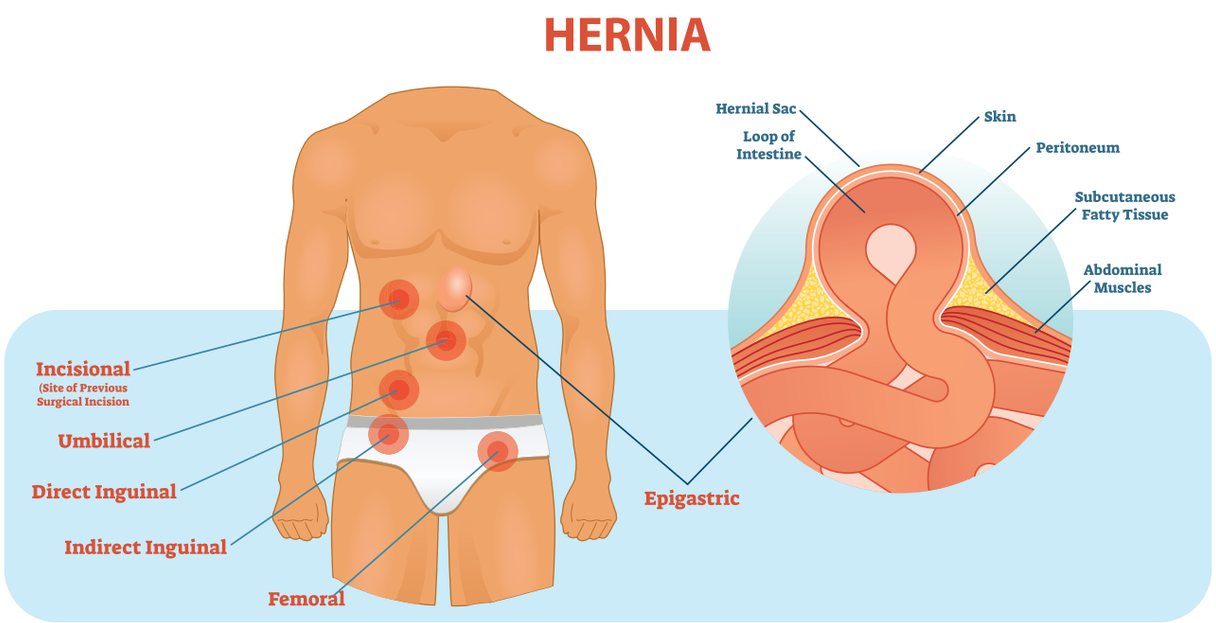
Hernia into two femoral canals appearing below the inguinal ligament that is below the groin.

3. **Umbilical hernia**

Protrusion of part of the intestine at the umbilicus due to failure of umbilical orifice will close. It occurs most often in obese women, in children and in patients with increased intra abdominal pressure from cirrhosis and ascites.

4. **Ventral (or) incisional hernia**

Hernia through the weak abdominal wall



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